

Romans

The Free Gift (review)

Chapter 5:12-21

Whom Do You Now Serve?

Chapter 6

A Context Check

Summary of Paul's Key Points

What Paul has shown us thus far:

- Man, standing on his own record, has failed miserably. (ch 1-3)
- Man, may obtain acquittal (imputed righteousness) independent of his moral excellence or performance. (v 3:24)
- What then was the purpose of the Law (v 3:31)? A summary discourse is thus in order. (ch 4)
- Man, justified by Grace through Faith in Christ, is given every spiritual blessing. (ch 5:1-11)
- Mankind has gone the way of Adam, and thus sin has reigned. Spiritual death is the result of that way. (ch 5:12-14)
- Mankind has now been offered the free gift of righteousness within God's Grace by way of Jesus Christ's remarkable atonement. This gift serves to demonstrate how much more powerful is God's Grace over the power of sin. Eternal life is the result of that way. (ch 5:15-21)

Blessings by Type Contrast

Adam’s Record versus Christ’s Record

Adam (our representative)	Christ (our representative)
One man’s offense (v15) • <i>Many died</i>	One man’s free gift • <i>Righteousness to many</i>

“But the free gift is not like the offense. For if by the one man’s offense many died, much more the grace of God and the gift by the grace of the one Man, Jesus Christ, abounded to many.” (Rom. 5:15)

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One man’s offense (v15) • <i>Many died</i>	One man’s free gift • <i>Righteousness to many</i>
That which thus came (v16) • <i>Judgment, condemnation</i>	That which thus came • <i>Gift of justification</i>

“And the gift is not like that which came through the one who sinned. For the judgment which came from one offense resulted in condemnation, but the free gift which came from many offenses resulted in justification.” (Rom. 5:16)

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Adam (our representative)	Christ (our representative)
One man’s offense (v15) Many died	One man’s free gift Righteousness to many
That which thus came (v16) Judgment, condemnation	That which thus came Gift of justification
Through one man (v17) Death reigns	Through one man Believers reign in life

“For if by the one man’s offense death reigned through the one, much more those who receive abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness will reign in life through the One, Jesus Christ.”
(Rom. 5:17)

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One man’s offense (v15) • <i>Many died</i>	One man’s free gift • <i>Righteousness to many</i>
That which thus came (v16) • <i>Judgment, condemnation</i>	That which thus came • <i>Gift of justification</i>
Through one man (v17) • <i>Death reigns</i>	Through one man • <i>Believers reign in life</i>
One man’s offense (v18) • <i>Condemnation to all</i>	Righteousness of One • <i>Justification offered all</i>

*“Therefore, as through one man’s offense judgment came to all men, resulting in condemnation, even so through one Man’s righteous act the free gift came to all men, resulting in justification of life.”
(Rom. 5:18)*

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That which thus came (v16) • <i>Judgment, condemnation</i>	That which thus came • <i>Gift of justification</i>
Through one man (v17) • <i>Death reigns</i>	Through one man • <i>Believers reign in life</i>
One man’s offense (v18) • <i>Condemnation to all</i>	Righteousness of One • <i>Justification offered all</i>
Disobedience of one (v19) • <i>Many made sinners</i>	Obedience of one • <i>Many made righteous</i>

“For as by one man’s disobedience many were made sinners, so also by one Man’s obedience many will be made righteous.”
(Rom. 5:19)

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Through one man (v17) • <i>Death reigns</i>	Through one man • <i>Believers reign in life</i>
One man’s offense (v18) • <i>Condemnation to all</i>	Righteousness of One • <i>Justification offered all</i>
Disobedience of one (v19) • <i>Many made sinners</i>	Obedience of one • <i>Many made righteous</i>
Ultimate result (v21) • <i>Sin reigns in death</i>	Ultimate result • <i>Grace reigns in eternal life</i>

“Moreover, the law entered that the offense might abound. But where sin abounded, grace abounded much more, so that as sin reigned in death, even so grace might reign through righteousness to eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.” (Rom. 5:20-21)

More Blessings?

What next?

“Justification”

- **Declares** within God's Holy Court that a sinner has been **imputed** righteousness (by Faith through Grace, as it has always been).
- **But has the sinner's heart changed?**

“Sanctification” Romans 6 thru Romans 8

- The believer is now free from the **penalty** of sin (i.e. spiritual death), but what about from the **power** of sin?
- God has a plan within the context of Salvation whereby He not only **declares** a sinner righteous, but He is also going to **make** a sinner righteous.
- A way that a sinner may grow in grace and thus become “set apart” for God. (v6:14)

United with the One, Jesus Christ

How are we changed?

*“What shall we say then? Shall we continue in sin that grace may abound? Certainly not! How shall we who **died to sin** live any longer in it? Or, do you not know that as many of us as were **baptized into Christ Jesus** were **baptized into His death**? Therefore we were **buried** with Him through **baptism into death**, that just as Christ was **raised from the dead** by the glory of the Father, even so we also should walk in **newness of life**.”*
*For if we have been **united together** in the **likeness of His death**, certainly we also shall be in the **likeness of His resurrection**,...”*
Romans 6:1-5

- *Does Paul assume that his readers were baptized into Christ? Does he also assume this to have been something of significance?*
- *In this passage, is Paul teaching that baptism is essential for union with Christ?*
- *Why does Paul mention baptism here? Is there a significance relative to the previous passage contrasting the power of sin versus the power of grace?*

How is the Baptism into Christ akin to entering into a Covenant Relationship with Jesus the Christ?

How is this baptism different from any other (Acts 19:1-6).